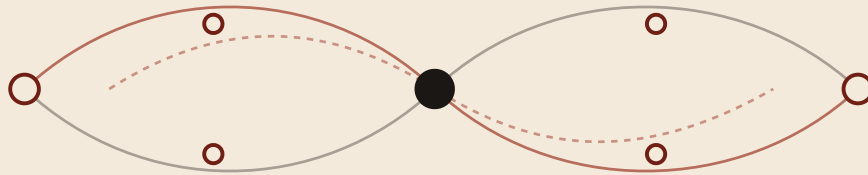


A High-Level View of Work Context Infrastructure



1. From perception to intention

All work begins, at least in some form, with an idea about something that could be different. Someone observes something in their life or in the reality around them and perceives a possibility, a need, a problem, or a condition worth preserving. From that perception, an objective begins to take shape.

The objective does not appear in isolation. Perception is situated. People encounter reality through lenses influenced by their experience, knowledge, biological constitution, social position, and cultural context. These factors do not mechanically determine one conclusion, but they influence what becomes visible, which distinctions seem important, and which possibilities can be imagined.

At first, the objective often appears as a single monolithic intention: one large, still formless whole with little internal detail or clarity. A person may sense a direction before they can describe the destination precisely. They may know that something should change without yet knowing the work, constraints, or sequence required to change it. The intention carries a purpose, but its parts, relationships, and much of its meaning remain implicit.

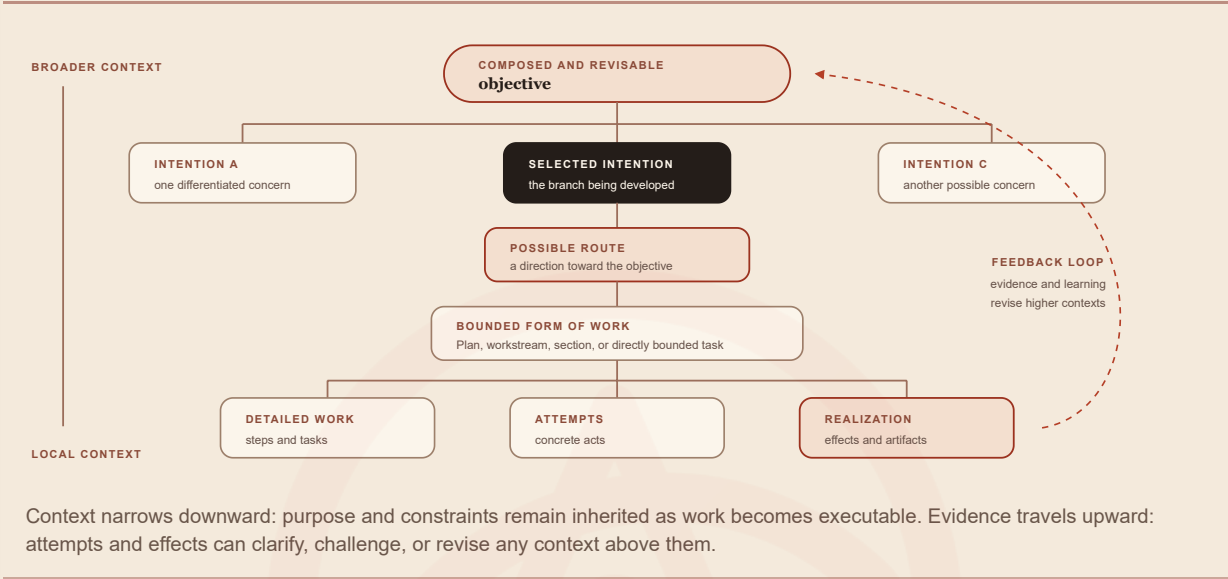
2. From a monolithic intention to a composition of intentions

As time and effort are invested, the monolithic intention begins to acquire contour. Distinctions appear inside it: outcomes, constraints, questions, and possible routes that were previously fused. Some of these distinctions become separate intentions, each with its own objective, scope, and possible work. Together, they compose the initial objective rather than merely sitting beneath it. The relationship is also recursive: what is learned while pursuing one of these intentions may clarify, challenge, or change the objective from which it emerged.



A more specific intention may become a possible route. When that route needs its own proposal identity, authority search, and lifecycle, it may become a Plan. It may instead remain a section, workstream, task, or another bounded form of work. In either case, the route can be developed into steps, each described more closely in terms of what needs to be done and, sometimes, how it might be done.

As an intention is differentiated, work acquires a hierarchy of contexts. Each lower context makes one portion of the objective more concrete without becoming detached from the broader purpose that explains it.



A possible route may instead become one directly bounded task; the sequence above is an illustrative decomposition, not a required lifecycle.

The intention does not merely become longer. It becomes composed of more parts. What was once held together as one idea begins to appear across conversations, Plans, research, decisions, specifications, assignments, tasks, attempts, and changed files.

This makes focused work possible, but it changes what is visible. Attention moves closer to the individual parts. A task may remain understandable by itself while the objective that made it worth doing becomes difficult to see. Several tasks may be completed correctly even after the assumption, feature, or larger purpose they were meant to serve has changed.

The work becomes more precise locally while its purpose becomes less visible globally.



3. What continuity would make possible

As work becomes divided, its meaning is distributed across many places. A project contains tasks; a specification carries traces of research and discussion; a decision rests on assumptions that may no longer be visible. The practical promise of work-context infrastructure is modest: to let a person recover those relationships when they matter.

Instead of treating each document, task, or artifact as an isolated object, the system would help it remain part of a larger and revisable story.

FROM A PROJECT	see which tasks, attempts, and results gradually composed it.
FROM A SPECIFICATION	recover the research, questions, and interpretations that refined what it came to say.
FROM A DECISION	understand the assumptions, alternatives, evidence, and authority behind it.
FROM AN ARTIFACT	trace the work that produced it and the objective it was meant to advance.
FROM AN OBJECTIVE	follow the work outward and notice what remains incomplete, uncertain, or no longer aligned.

The aim is not to produce a perfect account of work. It is to make forgetting less automatic: to preserve enough continuity that people can revisit why something exists, how it changed, and whether it still belongs to the purpose that first gave it meaning.

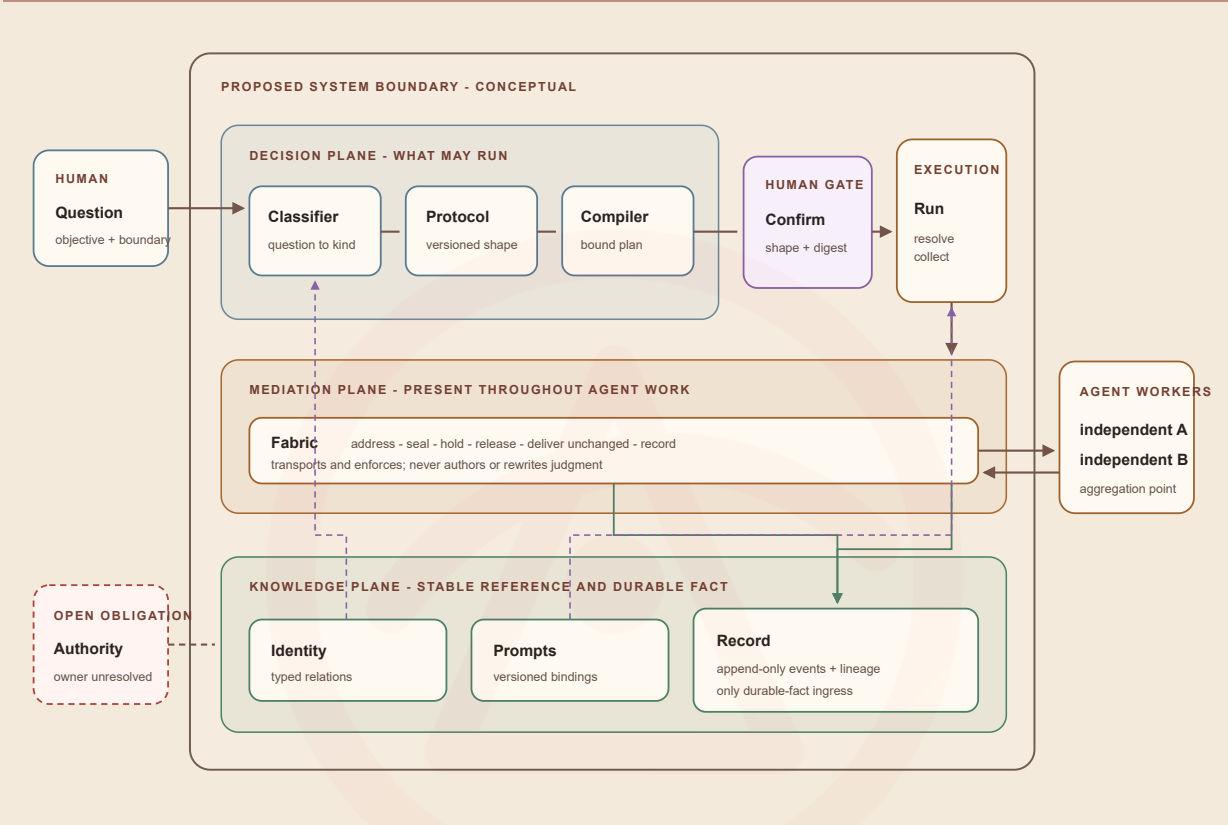
CONNECTED	ATTRIBUTABLE	REVISABLE	HONEST ABOUT GAPS
Work can point beyond itself toward the contexts that explain it.	Ideas, judgments, and actions retain a visible source.	Later learning can change earlier understanding without erasing its history.	Missing or conflicting context remains visible rather than being guessed.



4. One possible shape for the infrastructure

The diagram offers one possible arrangement, not a finished architecture. Its purpose is to show a few useful separations: deciding what work should happen, carrying it out, mediating contributions, and preserving what can later be known about the run.

A human question enters at the top. Work is shaped and confirmed before execution, contributions pass through a shared fabric, and identities, instructions, and recorded events keep the result connected to its history.



The boundaries are conceptual. Several responsibilities may initially live in one component. What matters is that a system can distinguish a proposed route from its execution, an agent's contribution from its transport, and a current conclusion from the record through which it became credible. Authority remains deliberately open.

SHAPE BEFORE ACTION

The work can be inspected before people or agents begin carrying it out.

PRESERVE THE VOICE

Mediation helps contributions move without quietly rewriting who said what.

REMEMBER CHANGE

The record keeps later revision connected to the path that made revision possible.

